

World History





About the Course

Through the reading of history stories and biographies, students experience what life was like in different times and places. They are exposed to the everyday experiences as well as the major events from our current history cycle (1800-1900). Students will also view images, reference maps, and work on their century charts and Book of Centuries as part of their lessons.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grade 4 (U.S.), History: Grade 4 (Canada), History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.), History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

This course is the same for 4th-6th graders. In grade 5, students may begin their Book of Centuries.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
4-6	World History: Grades 4-6 1 time/week 25 min	William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter Under the Hawthorn Tree Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grade 4 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	
History: Grade 4 (Canada)				
	Canadian History: Grades 2-4		World History: Grades 4-6	
History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6
History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)				
	Canadian History: Grades 5-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grade 4 (U.S.)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

☐ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.

History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

☐ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

World History: Grades 4-6



William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter



Under the Hawthorn Tree



Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



World History: Grades 4-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 1

Hunger

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ INTRO

1. When you think of Ireland, what comes to mind? Perhaps the story of St. Patrick. Ireland is often called the Emerald Isle because of its lush greenery. It is considered an enchanting place to visit.
∞ Image Link: The Cliffs of Moher

2. However, in the 1840s tragedy struck Ireland that changed it forever. There was a terrible famine and many people either died or left the country to go to America. Today one-sixth of US citizens (43 million) identify their national background as Irish. What was it like to live in Ireland at this time? This book is a fictional account of an Irish family during that time and what they did to survive. It is hard to read about such a sad time in history and all the suffering that happened. But we also read about those who persevered and had hope for a brighter future. The author is from Ireland and has sequels to this book if you want to read more. Let's first learn about the geography of Ireland.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Student World Atlas p.82-83 & ∞ Map Link: Ireland

1. In what continent is Ireland located? (Europe)
2. What large ocean lies west of Ireland? (The Atlantic Ocean)
3. Which country is directly east of Ireland across the Irish Sea? (United Kingdom-England, Wales, Scotland)
4. What sea lies between them? (The Irish Sea)
5. What is the capital city of Ireland? (Dublin)
6. Now look at the link for the map of Ireland to answer the rest of the questions. Find Cork in the southern part of Ireland. The characters in this story live in Duneen which lies in the region of Cork.
7. What river lies runs through Cork? (River Lee)
8. What mountain range runs along parts of Ireland's east coast? (The Wicklow Mountains)
9. What is the longest river in Ireland? (The River Shannon)
10. Which part of Ireland is generally more mountainous—the east or the west? (The west)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. A Simple History of the Great Famine p.121-123
2. Ch.1
- What do you think about the different reaction from the men and women that author mentions on p.2—"the men cursed and the women prayed to God to save them"?

→ VIEW

These are photographs of traditional farmhouses or cottages in Ireland in the 1800s.

∞ Image Links: Traditional Cottages, Inside of Cottages

• EXTRA HELPING

This is a good overview about the famine that sets the context for the book.

∞ Video Link: Irish Potato Famine

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 2

Under the Hawthorn Tree, Nothing to Eat

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

During this time in Ireland, people used turf to heat their homes and cook

★ TEACHER NOTE

P.10 talks about the death of their baby sister.



Term 1

their food. Turf also known as peat was harvested from a bog, which is a kind of wetland. Turf or peat is dead plant matter that hardens and turns into People would have to go to the bog to cut turf by hand and dry them in the sun before they could be used for fuel. This process will be mentioned in the chapter.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Peat stocks

This picture shows the stocks of peat that were being sliced and taken from the bog.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-beginning of Ch.3 p.9-20 Beginning-"her brave brother."

- How would you describe the religious beliefs of the family?
- Why do you think the children didn't show hospitality to the woman and her son?

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 3

Nothing to Eat, On Their Own

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Here is a little more background information about the potato disease or blight. "Almost overnight, healthy green fields of potatoes turned black. Prior to the blight, many Irish families relied on potatoes as their primary food source. The average man ate 14 pounds of potatoes a day. Mixed with buttermilk, potatoes provided a nutritious diet for hard working laborers. Ireland was unprepared for the recurring failure of the potato crop in the years 1845–1849. As it turned out, the crop failure was due to a fungus that was unknown at the time, which is now believed to have been phytophthora infestans. Approximately 40 percent of the crop was lost in 1845, however, it did not lead to famine, as surplus from the previous year sustained the population along with some government relief. The next year's harvest was expected to be healthy and plentiful. However, in 1846, the blight returned to the potato crop in Ireland, and relief from the government in England was slow and inadequate. Soon disease and death spread across the country" (From Great Hunger Museum).

→ VIEW

The potato plant grow undergrounds. Potatoes are grown by planting seed potatoes—sprouted chunks of old potatoes—which form multiple new tubers underground, typically five to six per seed piece. Usually after 90–135 days when the plant's foliage has browned and fully died back it is ready to be picked.

∞ Image Link: Potato Plant

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.3 and begin ch.4, p.20-30 "The sky had" - "of the blankets."

- How would you have answered Eily when she said, "Sometimes I wonder does God even know what is happening down here—his world is so vast and big"?
- Did you notice some of the unfamiliar words in this chapter—a ghile (p.23) and a stór (p.24)? Those words come from the Irish language, also known as Gaelic or Gaelige, The origins of the Irish language can be traced back to the 4th century AD, when it evolved from a common Celtic

• DEFINITIONS

draper shop: a dealer in cloth and sometimes also in clothing and dry goods (p.24)

a ghile: a Gaelic expression of endearment, such as my darling (p.23)

a stór: a Gaelic expression that means my treasure (p.24)

World History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

language spoken by the ancient Celts who lived in Ireland. When England took control of Ireland, the English language became more common than Gaelic, although some words have carried over.

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 4

On Their Own, The Road to the Workhouse

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Until about 1900 the greater part of the land in Ireland (97% in 1870) was owned by landlords who rented it out to tenant farmers rather than cultivating it themselves. The tenant farmers would grow crops and raise animals on the land and either pay the landlord with money or crops. Many of the landlords lived in England and had an overseer to manage everyday affairs.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.4 and begin ch. 5, p.30-41 "All the next" - "to keep hidden."

- What do you think of their decision to not go to the workhouses and try to find their aunts? What are the risks?

• DEFINITIONS

boreen: (a narrow country lane (p.35)

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 5

The Road to the Workhouse, Follow the River

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

Workhouses were built by the government before the famine as places of refuge for those who were unable to support themselves, often due to extreme poverty. A typical day inside a workhouse was to rise at 6am, breakfast at 6.30am, work until 12noon, lunch break and then work until 6pm. Supper was served at 7pm, with lights out at 8pm. Husbands, wives and children were separated as they entered the workhouse and could be punished if they attempted to speak to each other. An inmate's only possessions were his/her uniform, mattress and blanket. Once a week the inmates bathed and the men shaved. The conditions were unsanitary and the conditions were harsh because they didn't want people to go to the workhouses unless it was the last resort. However, during the famine more and more people had no other choice.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.5 and begin ch.6, p.41-51 "Eily, Eily" - "happened to them."

- What do you think Mary Kate meant by the advice to give to the children, "Let nature be your friend and help." (p.45)

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Picture of a workhouse

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 6

Follow the River, The Soup Kitchen

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?



Term 1

→ INTRO

History is complicated and it is hard to simplify all the conflict that existed between Protestant England and Catholic Ireland at the time. The Acts of Union in 1800 that created the United Kingdom had declared that Ireland, a predominately Catholic country, would be directly under British rule. Many farms in Ireland were owned by English absentee landlords. The Irish were, in effect, second-class citizens in their own country. This background will help you understand some of the hardships in this book and why England didn't provide as much help as they should have.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.5 and ch.6 p.51-61 "By next morning" - "yet another good-bye."

- Did you notice what the old man said to them? He told them to leave as the heathens might try to convert them.(p.59). And they were mentioned as strange religious folk on p.57. Many soup kitchens were set up by Protestant groups and since most Irish people were Catholic, the man was warning the children. The author is showing the tension that existed in Ireland between the Catholics Irish and English Protestants.

WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 7

Beside the Lake, At the Harbor

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

Note: We are skipping ch.8 for the sake of time and the graphic descriptions of starvation and death.

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

You may be wondering why the Irish were so dependent on the potato and why they didn't they have other crops? "Potatoes are not native to Ireland but likely originated in the Andes Mountains of Peru, South America. In the early 1500s, Spanish conquerors found the Incas growing the vegetable, which the Spanish called patata. They were taken back to Europe and eventually reached England where the name changed to potato. About 1590, potatoes were introduced to Ireland where farmers quickly discovered they thrived in their country's cool moist soil with very little labor. An acre of fertilized potato field could yield up to 12 tons of potatoes, enough to feed a family of six for a year with leftovers going to the family's animals. By the 1800s, the potato had become the staple crop in the poorest regions. More than three million Irish peasants subsisted solely on the vegetable which is rich in protein, carbohydrates, minerals, and vitamins such as riboflavin, niacin and Vitamin C. Irish peasants were actually healthier than peasants in England or Europe where bread, far less nutritious, was the staple food" (from the historyplace.com). Although the potato crop failed, some farmers in Ireland were still growing wheat, oats, barley and other crops that were exported to England. That is why many Irish people blamed England for not helping them as much as they could have. You will read more about that in today's reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-part of ch.10 p.73-80 Beginning - "Let's leave it."

- How have the children matured and changed since leaving their house?

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 8

At the Harbor, Traveling by Night

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?



Term 1

→ INTRO

While many people stayed in Ireland hoping for an end to the famine, millions of people emigrated (to leave one's country to live elsewhere) to other places. Between 1845 and 1855, nearly 2 million people emigrated from Ireland to America and Australia, and another 750,000 to Britain. The Poor Law Extension Act, which made landlords responsible for the maintenance of their own poor, urged the landlords to pay for their tenants to leave the country. However, emigrating was not an easy solution. Ships were overcrowded, and many people died before reaching their new home. Disease spread quickly onboard because people were packed in so close together. These ships became known as "coffin ships" because so many people died aboard them.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.10-12 p.80-88 "Eily and Peggy" - "by day again."

- On p. 84 the author says that Eily realizes just how young Peggy is and how brave she is. How do you think this kind of journey will change the children's understanding of themselves and the world around them?

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 9

Peggy's Fever, Michael's Desperate Search

 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

PREP: You may want to read the PDF titled "How Can God Be Good and Allow Evil and Suffering?" so you can discuss these issues with your student as you see fit. This issue is addressed by one of the characters at the end of today's reading.

∞ PDF Link:How Can God Be Good and Allow Evil and Suffering? (from corechristianity.com)

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13-part of ch.14, p.89-97 Beginning- "was a monster."

- Does that last sentence bother you? What would you say to Michael?

WEEK 10 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 10

Michael's Desperate Search, The Cow, Castletaggart

 Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ INTRO

This tragedy impacted the population of Ireland and the population of Irish immigrant in America. Between the famine and people emigrating to other places, you can see the decrease in population and also how it continued after the famine. The population never again reached the size it was before the famine.

(4 years before famine) 1841—8 million

(During famine) 1851—6 million

(After famine) 1871—4 million

2017—4.75 million

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.14-start of ch.16, p.97-109 "Eily kept watching" - "them some relief."

World History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 11

Castletaggart, Journey's End

Materials: Under the Hawthorn Tree

→ RECAP

What happened last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.16-17, p.109-119 "A priest passed" - end.

- What are some characteristics you would you use to describe the children?
- What did you learn about the Irish Famine from this historical novel that you wouldn't have learned if you just read about it in a non-fiction book?

→ VIEW

Did you notice all the times the hawthorn tree was mentioned, including the title of the book? Watch this video to see why hawthorn trees are significant to Irish folklore.

∞ Video Link: Hawthorn Trees (just watch 1:54-4:35)

• DEFINITIONS

demesne: the land attached to an estate (p.107)

WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 12

→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.

Questions will come from: Under the Hawthorn Tree

World History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 13

The Slave Auction, A Letter from a Schoolboy

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ INTRO

This book is about an Englishman named William Wilberforce (1759-1833) who was a member of Parliament, the lawmaking group in the government of Great Britain. The English had been part of the slave trade since 1662. In 1770, out of a total of one hundred thousand slaves a year from West Africa, British ships transported more than half. English considered the slave trade inseparably linked with the wealth and national security of Great Britain. William worked tirelessly in Parliament to change the laws and abolish or get rid of the slave trade. As we learn about this remarkable man, we will also learn about what life was like in the late 1700's and early 1800s, what people were thinking about, talking about, and how it was different from our life today. We are mostly studying the 1800-1900 this year but this book begins a little earlier in 1759 when William was born.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of England

Find Hull, which is a coastal city in northern England. This is where William was born.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.9-17 Beginning - "on their journey."

- How would describe the kind of family and lifestyle that William was born into?
- How is his life and opportunities different from the slaves we were introduced to in the first chapter?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Links: Birthplace of William Wilberforce which is now a museum, Portrait of William Wilberforce

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 14

A Letter from a Schoolboy, To Cambridge

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-26 "What's the coachman" - "law of gravity."

- What do you think it means that William's mom "was against anybody showing great enthusiasm" (p21) in their spiritual life?
- How would you describe William when he was a college student?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Photo of Cambridge University in the late 1800's.

• EXTRA HELPING

This tour of Cambridge University shows the architecture and setting of the school. (5:00)

∞ Video Link: Cambridge University

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 15

To Cambridge, The Shrimp who Swelled into a Whale

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ INTRO

When someone says they want to enter public service for their career, what do they mean? It usually means they want to get involved in

• DEFINITIONS

Chancellor of the Exchequer: the chief financial minister and as such is responsible for growing the UK economy.

World History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

government. It is important to know a little about the government of the United Kingdom (England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland) since our book takes place in England. Parliament is the **legislature** or lawmaking group. The government leader, called the prime minister, is always a member of Parliament. This makes Britain different from the United States, which keeps **Congress** and the president in separate branches of government. Parliament is made up of two houses: the House of Lords and the House of Commons. You will read about William's entrance into public service.

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.27-36 "William, despite his" - "said Pitt."

- How do you think most people that knew William Wilberforce would have described him?
- What kind of advantages did he have that allowed him to be elected to Parliament?

→ VIEW

William Wilberforce and William Pitt spent time in college in the Strangers Gallery watching the proceedings of Parliament. This picture shows the Houses of Parliament on the Thames River in London, England and the inside of the House of Commons that was built in 1834. In this picture, the gallery for public viewing is on the second floor above the entrance.

∞ Image Link: Houses of Parliament in London, Strangers Gallery

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 16

The Shrimp who Swelled into a Whale

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The year is 1783 and William Wilberforce and his friend William Pitt are on a six-week holiday in France. Think about what is happening in America. The Revolutionary War is just ending. The French Revolution will take place in 6 years later. William and William are going to meet Marie Antoinette, the queen of France, who was executed along with the king in 1793.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.36-42 "They were then" - "soul for eternity."

- What does the title of the chapter mean?

→ VIEW

You can look through the different pictures that show the Palace of Versailles.

∞ Image Link: Palace of Versailles

This video gives an overview of the life of Marie Antoinette as well as some misconceptions about her.

∞ Video Link: The Story of Marie Antoinette

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 17

Oh Happy Day

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.43-50 (whole chapter)

World History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- What kind of changes are happening with William?

→ **VIEW**

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 18

Amazing Grace

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ **RECAP**

What did you read last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.63-71

→ **VIEW**

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 19

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ **RECAP**

What did you read last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.73-82

→ **VIEW**

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 20

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ **RECAP**

What did you read last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.83-95

→ **VIEW**

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 21

Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter

→ **RECAP**

What did you read last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.97-103

→ **VIEW**

∞ Image Link:

World History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 10 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 22 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter →RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.105- → VIEW ∞ Image Link:	
WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 23 Materials: William Wilberforce: The Freedom Fighter →RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.105-114 → VIEW ∞ Image Link:	
WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 24 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: WILLIAM WILBERFORCE: THE FREEDOM FIGHTER	

World History: Grades 4-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 25

Aliens Arrive

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun, Student World Atlas

→INTRO

This is a non-fiction book that tells the story of how U.S. Navy ships headed by Commodore Matthew Perry ships sailed to Japan in 1853 to bring a letter from President Fillmore asking Japan to open their ports to trading with the U.S. Other attempts had been tried before but were unsuccessful. Due to policies in Japan, they had remained isolated from most other countries for hundreds of years. Imagine you are living in your small fishing village of Shimoda and had never met anyone from another country. You see four huge ships approaching. That is what it was like for the people on that day in July 8, 1853. Let's first learn about the geography of Japan.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Student World Atlas p.30-31, 92-92

- 1.On which continent is Japan found? (Asia)
- 2.How would you get from the U.S. to Japan in a ship if you were going to leave from the east coast? (Sail east across the Atlantic Ocean, around the southern tip of Africa, and across the Indian Ocean and western Pacific in between Sumatra and Malaysia).
- 3.Which countries are closest to Japan? (North and South Korea, Russia, China)
- 4.Is Japan north or south of the equator? (north)
- 5.What is the capital of Japan? (Tokyo)
- 6.Turn to p.91-92. How many main islands is Japan made up of? (4) Name them. (Hokkaido, Honshu, Shikoku, Kyushu) There are also nearly 4,000 smaller islands!
- 7.Which island is the largest? (Honshu)
- 8.What bodies of water surround Japan? (the Pacific Ocean, Sea of Japan / East Sea, East China Sea, Sea of Okhotsk)
- 9.What physical features cover much of Japan? (Almost four-fifths of Japan is covered with mountains.)
- 10.Why might Japan's island location have helped protect it from invasions?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-start of Ch.2 p.13-20 Beginning-"ship to leave."

- Why do you think the title of the first chapter is "Aliens Arrive"?
- Why might they think American ships are not coming on friendly terms?

→ VIEW

- 1.∞ Image Links: Chart of Feudal System & Japanese Society
Japan was still based on a feudal society which means society was divided into strict social classes where everyone had a specific role that had to follow. Read the description of Japanese society and look at the chart that shows the feudal system and who has the most power and the least power.
- 2.Look at the illustrations at the beginning of the book and in ch.1 Then read about the illustrations on p.138. Most of the illustrations come that time period from either Japanese artists or American artists that were part of the expedition.

• DEFINITIONS

turmoil: a state or condition of extreme confusion (p.14)

inept:(p.15) lacking qualities (as knowledge, skill, or ability) required to do a job

• EXTRA HELPING

The Japanese had never seen a steamship. If you are interested to learn more about steamships watch this video.

∞ **Video Link:** The Story of Steamships (2:55-5:00)

World History: Grades 4-6

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Term 3

WEEK 2 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 26

The Black Ships of Evil Men; His High and Mighty Mysteriousness

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The four Americans ships full of 560 men of the U.S. Navy have arrived off the coast of Japan and now we will find out how the Japanese will respond. What do you think they will do?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Finish ch.2-ch.3 p.20-29

- Why do you think Commodore Perry stood firm on his decision to not sail to the port in Nagasaki or meet with lower officials? (Interesting note: It was said that Perry realized that previous failures had resulted from insufficient show of strength and ignorance of Japanese character, two mistakes he would never make.)
- What are the some of the differences you notice so far between the Americans and Japanese?

moored: anchored (p.20)

WEEK 3 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 27

Landing on Sacred Soil

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.Ch.4 p.30-36

- What stood out to you about the meeting?
- 2.Read the letter from President Fillmore that is found in Appendix A, p.123-124
- Do you think the letter was persuasive? What do you think about the reasons he gave for opening trade?

→ VIEW

Discuss the illustration on p.32-33 and details you remember from the reading.

• DEFINITIONS

cutlass: a short curving sword formerly used by sailors on warships (p.31)

pikemen: soldier with a heavy spear with a very long shaft (p.31)

anteroom: a small outer room that leads to another room and that is often used as a waiting room (p.34)

capacious: wide or huge (p.36)

abrogate: to put an end to by formal action (p.124)

WEEK 4 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 28

The Dutch Island Prison, Foreigners Forbidden

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The only Western country that had been allowed to trade with Japan was the Netherlands which began trade in 1608. The Dutch traders were confined to an artificial island and had many rules to follow. You will read about that in this chapter. Then the next chapter will explain why the Japanese were cut off from the rest of the world and how it had not always been that way.

→ LOCATE

∞ Map Link: Map of Japan

Find Nagasaki in the western side of Japan. The tiny island of Deshima

★ TEACHER NOTE

You may want to skip the last sentence on p.39 that tells about the actions of the Dutchmen before the Shoguns.



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was connected by bridge to Nagasaki.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.Ch.5 p.37-40

- Why do you think the Dutch put up with all those rules and requirements in order to have a trading station?

2.Ch.6 p.41-43

- Why do you think the Japanese mistrusted foreigners?

→ VIEW

This illustration from the Phillip von Siebold's book shows Deshima, the artificial island where the Dutch traders lived.

∞ Image Link: Illustration of Deshima.

WEEK 5 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 29

The Great Peace

📄 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

In this chapter you will learn more about the Japanese feudal system where everyone was born into a specific social class. You may want to write the names of the classes on a whiteboard or piece of paper as you read about them and put symbols or words that represent their roles and obligations.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.44-53

- What do you think the basis was for all the specific rules they had?
- How do you determine what rules a society should have and what rules take away personal freedom?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please note the reference to ritual suicide on p.48.

• DEFINITIONS

vassal: (p.47) a person who received protection and land from a lord in return for loyalty and service

saki: a Japanese alcoholic drink that is made from rice (p.52)

stratified: divided into social classes (p.53)

WEEK 6 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 30

Clouds Over the Land of the Rising Sun, The Black Ships Return

📄 Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun, Student World Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Student World Atlas, p.93

Find Hong Kong. (southeastern China) Commodore Perry and his men went to Hong Kong while they waited for the Japanese leaders to make their decision.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.Ch.8 p.54-59

- What do you think about some of the American customs that Manjiro found strange?
- 2.Begin Ch.9 63-65 Beginning-"to read documents."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the first paragraph on p.63 that talks about women and liquor and minstrel shows.

• DEFINITIONS

armaments: weapons (p.56)

quandary: a situation in which you are confused about what to do (p.57)

monotony: (p.65) a lack of change that makes something boring

World History: Grades 4-6

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WEEK 7 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 31

The Black Ships Return, The Treaty House

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Finish Ch.9 p.65-68 "During the long" - end of chapter.

2. Ch.10 p.69-77

- Perry didn't think the Japanese valued human life because of their treatment of the American sailors and some of the Japanese customs. What would it look like if a society valued human life?

→ VIEW

Discuss the illustrations on p.70-73 and details you remember from the reading.

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is mention of ritual suicides on p.76 in the last two paragraphs.

• DEFINITIONS

retainers: servants (p.69)

WEEK 8 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 32

An Array of Gifts

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

How do you feel when people give you gifts? Perry thought he would try to win over the Japanese by giving them all kinds of gifts that would be represent America.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 11 p.78-86

- Which gift of the Americans do you think was the most interesting?
- Which gift of the Japanese do you think was the most interesting?

→ VIEW

1. If you are interested, look at the list of gifts in Appendix C & D, p.127-130

2. The Japanese gave the Americans pieces of lacquerware. Lacquer, a shiny, hard surface is applied to materials such as wood or metal. Then pictures are painted on the objects.

∞ Image Link: Writing lacquer box

• EXTRA HELPING

One of the gifts the Americans brought to Japan was a telegraph. Watch this short video to learn about this invention.

∞ Video Link: The Telegraph

WEEK 9 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 33

The Grand Banquet, The Treaty

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 12-13 p.87-96

- Are you surprised by the concessions the Japanese made in the treaty?
- Why do you think they were now open to engaging with foreigners?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview content on p.91 that talks about a minstrel show.

• DEFINITIONS

diplomacy: the work of maintaining good relations between the governments of different countries (p.87)

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WEEK 10 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 34

Excursions on Land and Sea, Shore Leave

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

1.∞ Map Link: Shimoda, Japan

You will see that Shimoda is darkened on this map. This is one of the ports that the Americans are allowed to use. This is also the fishing village that was mentioned at the beginning of the book that first sighted the 4 black ships.

2.∞ Map Link: Hakodate, Japan

Hakodate is circled on the map. Where is it located in relation to Shimoda? This is the other port city that the Americans were allowed to go to.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 14-15 p.97-106

- What were some of the differences between the American customs and lifestyle and the Japanese?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview bottom of p.98 and top of p.99 that again mentions ritual suicide. P.102 talks about a bathhouse that is shared by both men and women.

• DEFINITIONS

daguerreotype: an early photograph produced on a silver or a silver-covered copper plate (p.103)

WEEK 11 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 35

In the Wake of the Black Ships

Materials: Commodore Perry in the Land of the Shogun

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 16, Afterward

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link:

WEEK 12 25m World History: Grades 4-6 - Lesson 36

→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.

QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: COMMODORE PERRY IN THE LAND OF THE SHOGUN